



 ThinkCollege  
**NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER**  
INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

# Paying for College

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A Think College National Coordinating Center  
Webinar

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# Presented by

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**NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER**

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

Federally funded since 2010 to provide coordination, training and technical assistance to any college or university who wants to establish or improve postsecondary education opportunities to students with intellectual disability on their campus, and to provide information and support to K-12 educators, families and students interested in PSE options.

<https://thinkcollege.net/projects/ncc>

# Paying for College: Exploring the Options

- Federal Financial Aid
- Scholarships
- Medicaid Funding
- Vocational Rehabilitation
- GI Bill
- Student Loans
- Social Security
- IDEA Funds
- Family Funds
- Student Contributions





# There are multiple funding sources...

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**BUT what is available can vary based on:**

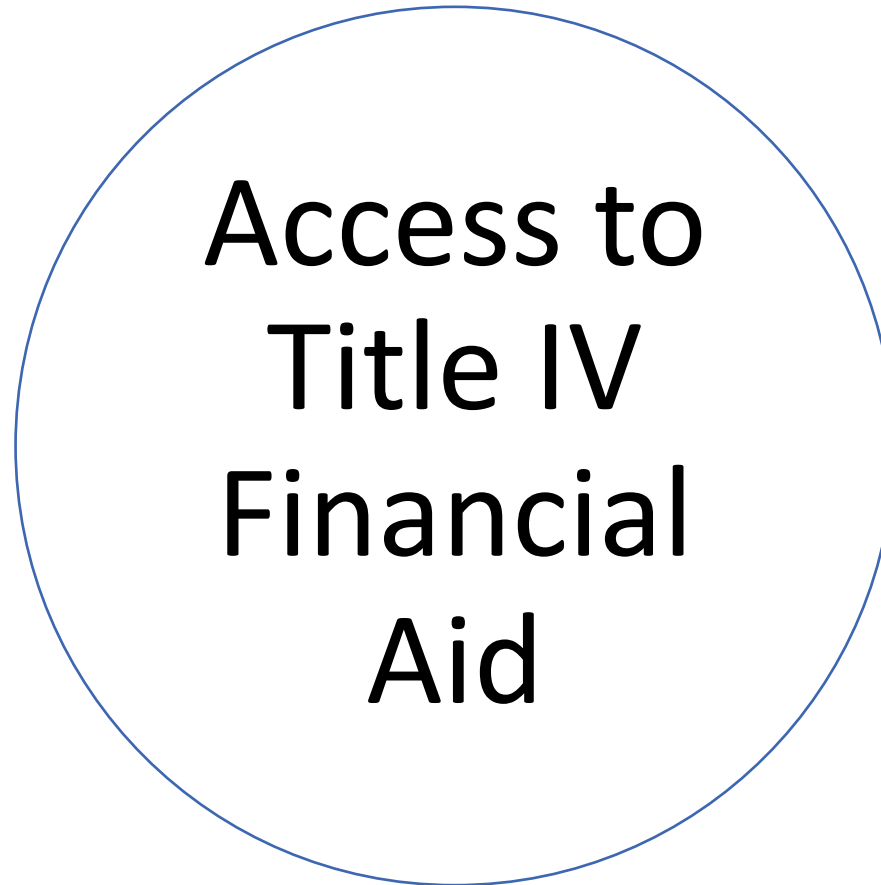
- Disability
- State of residence
- Availability of state-level services
- Family income
- Military service

# Federal Financial Aid

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- Must attend an approved Comprehensive Transition Program
- Do not need a regular high school diploma or to be working towards a degree
- Family income impacts the amount of financial aid

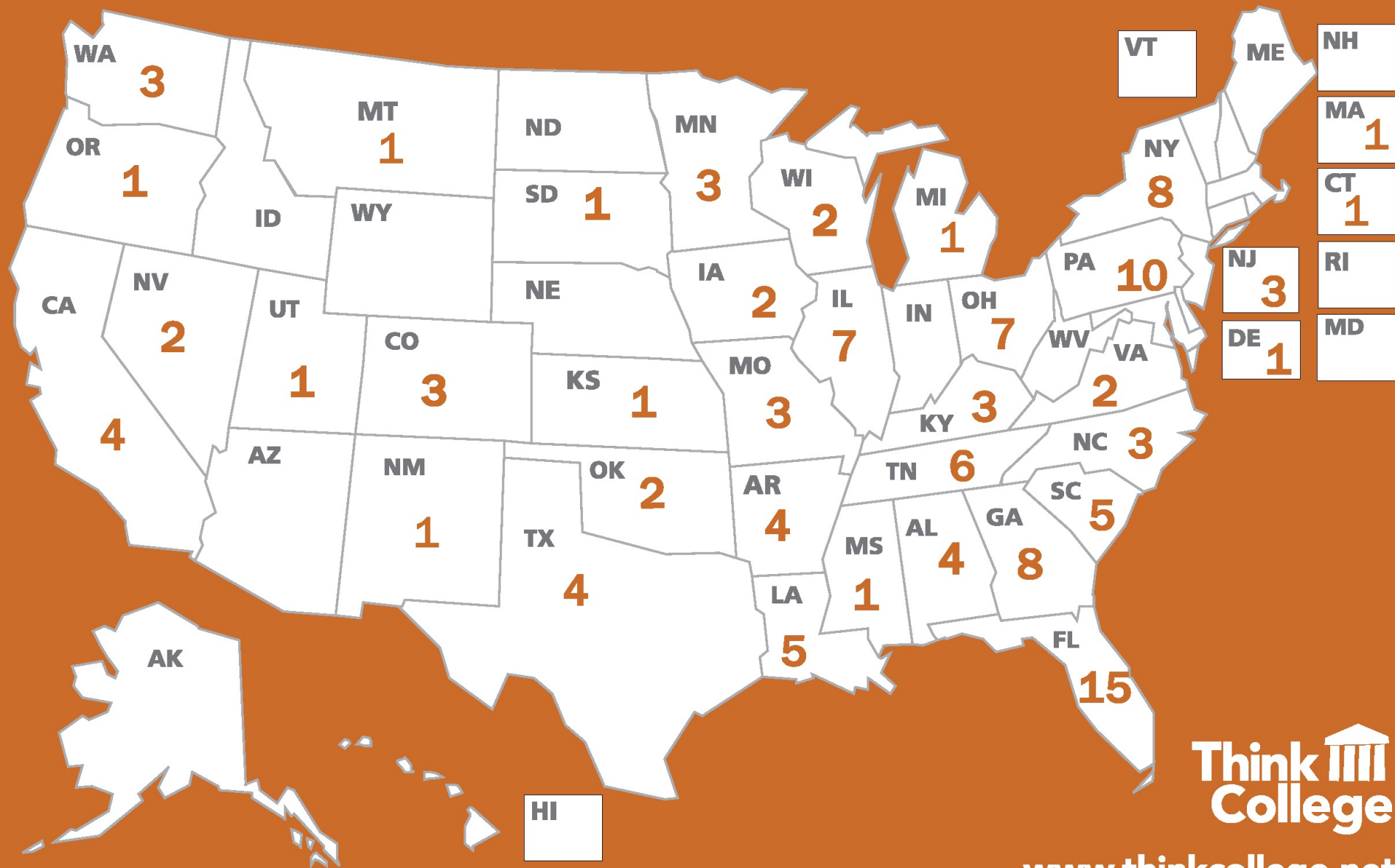




- Federal Pell Grant
- Federal Supplemental Education Opportunity Grant
- Federal Work-Study

# Approved Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) Programs April 2022

129 CTP Programs currently operating



Of the 314 college programs in Think College Search-

**129** are approved Comprehensive Transition Programs

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[www.thinkcollege.net](http://www.thinkcollege.net)



# Scholarships

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- Some are **disability specific** – ie. Ruby's Rainbow for students with Down syndrome
- Availability for students attending a **non-degree program**
- **State scholarship programs** are growing
- **Ask your guidance counselor** about local scholarships

# Medicaid Funding

- Availability varies by STATE
- Most common program involved is the Home and Community-Based Services (HBCS)
- Services that may be covered by Medicaid
  - Peer Mentor supports
  - Career Services
  - Tuition and Fees
  - Transportation
  - Assistive Technology
  - Housing and Supports

# Vocational Rehabilitation (VR)

VR is an eligibility and not an entitlement program.

Eligibility criteria:

- Presence of a disability related impairment
- Impairment results in one or more vocational impediments
- Requires VR services in order to achieve employment
- There is no financial criteria for eligibility.

Goal of VR is competitive integrated career-oriented employment

- Important to remember **this is the singular goal of the VR program**, not training itself. Support for training or postsecondary education is a means to that end of obtaining a good job.

# VR Support for Postsecondary Education (PSE)

VR does, but isn't **required** to, support postsecondary education

- However, it is a standard for many career-oriented jobs, and a large portion of VR funds is spent on PSE training, including inclusive postsecondary programs

VR may tell you they do not support IPSE, but the Rehab. Act and regulations do not support that position.

- 34 CFR 361.48(b): we clarify here that the vocational and other training services specified in final Section 361.48(b)(6) encompass tuition and other services for students with intellectual or developmental disabilities in a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program for Students with Intellectual Disabilities, as defined by the Higher Education Act of 2008.

## Veteran's Education Benefits (GI Bill)

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**Chapter 35** – Dependent Benefits  
are most applicable for students  
attending CTP programs

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For family members of those that  
lost their life or were permanently  
disabled in the line of duty

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BOTH the student and the program  
they attend **must be approved** by  
the Veteran's Administration

## Student Loan Programs

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Students attending approved CTP programs can access SOME federal student aid, but not loans

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Private-lender student or parent loans MAY be an option

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Check with the lender to determine if they provide loans to students in **non-degree programs**.



## Supplemental Security Income (SSI)

- Going to college does not make a person ineligible for Supplemental Security Income (SSI)
- Some students use their SSI funds to pay for college
- PASS plans allow people to set aside income that is being used to support college attendance



# IDEA Funds

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- College-based transition services for students who are still under IDEA Services
- Typically established as a program between a school district(s) and a local college or university
- Can advocate for transition services to occur on a college campus



# Family Funds and Student Contributions

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- ABLE Accounts
- 529 Plans
- Funds from after-school and summer jobs

# Questions?

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In case we run out of time or  
you have questions later:

[ThinkCollegeTA@gmail.com](mailto:ThinkCollegeTA@gmail.com)

